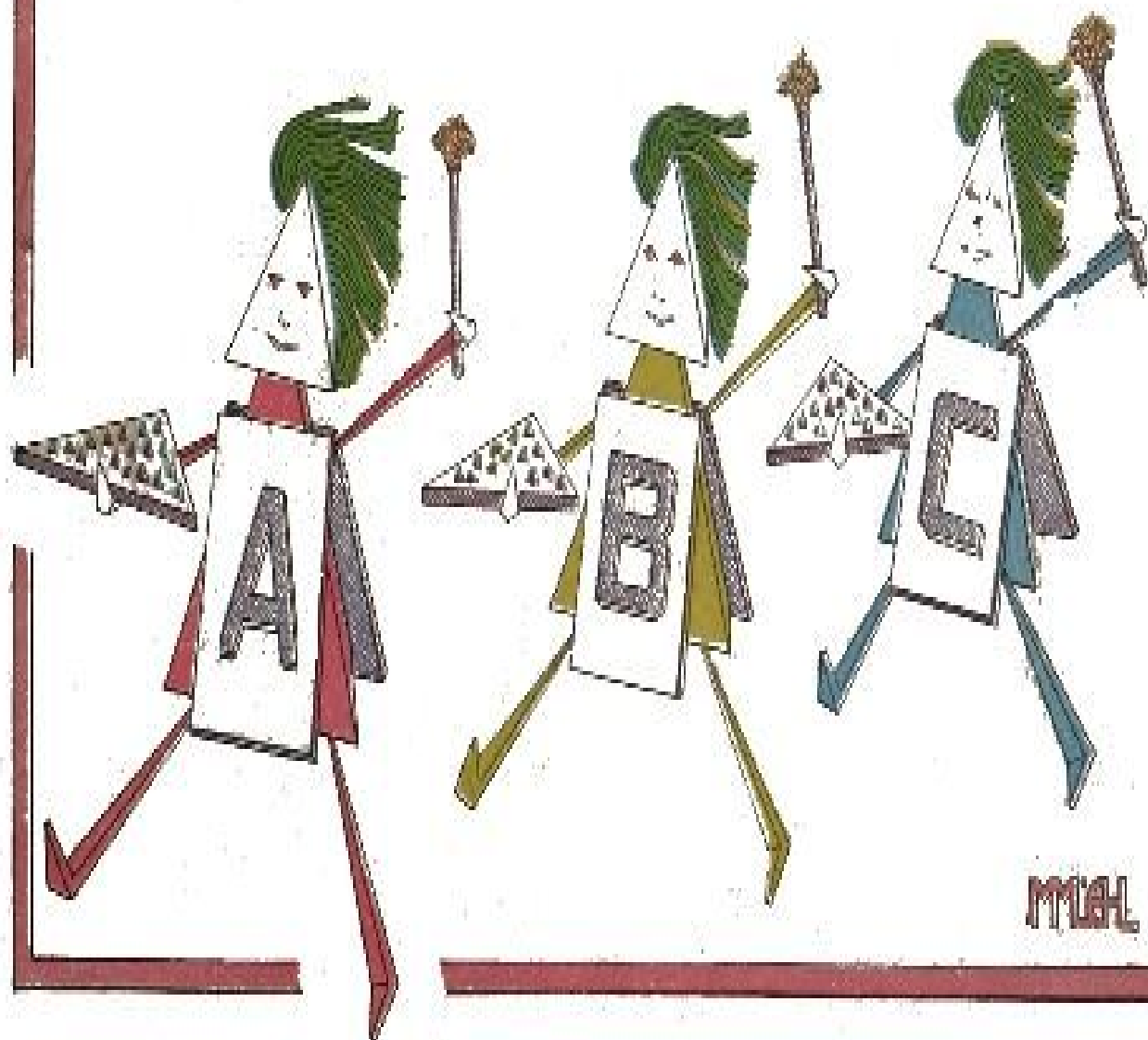


THE CUBIES



THE CUBIES



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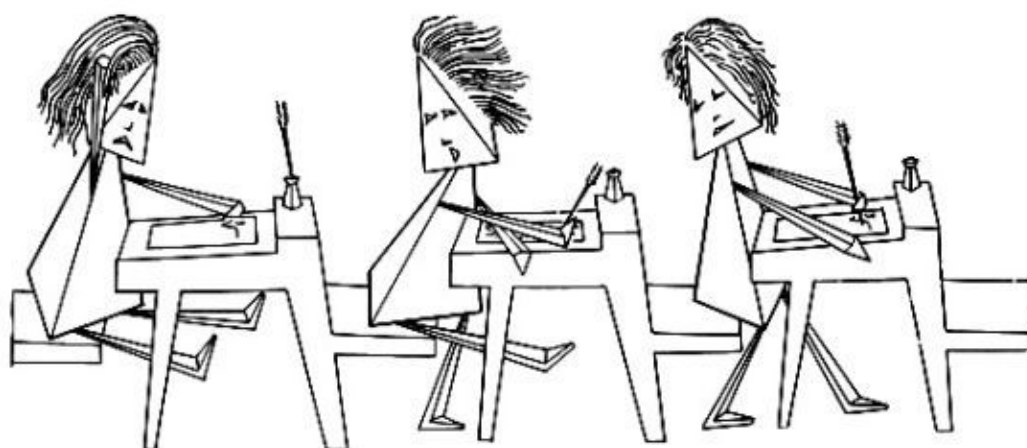
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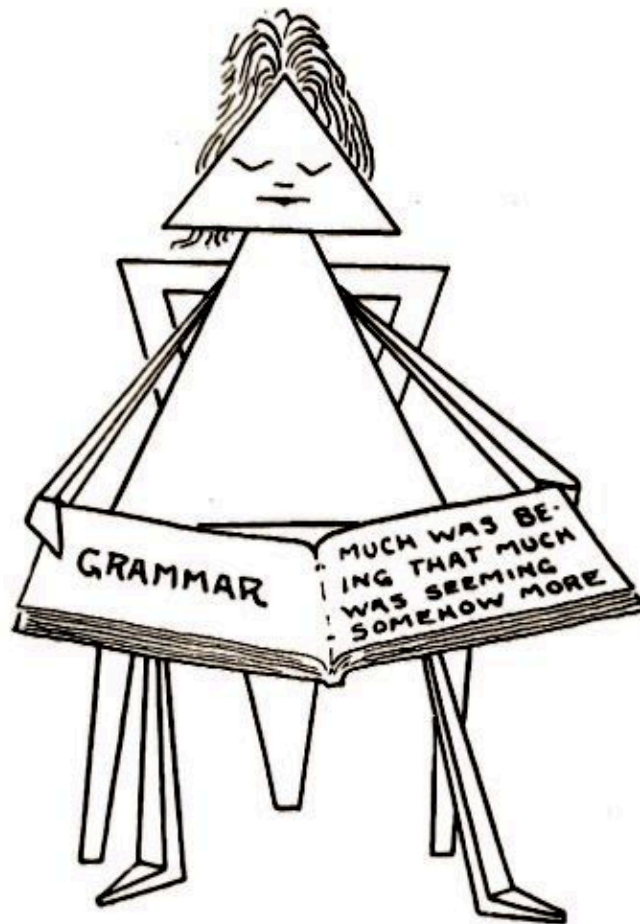
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*** START OF THE PROJECT GUTENBERG EBOOK THE CUBIES' ABC





GRAMMAR
MUCH WAS BEING THAT MUCH WAS SEEMING SOMEHOW MORE

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VERSED BY
MARY MILLS LYALL

PICTURED BY
EARL HARVEY LYALL



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THE CUBIES' ABC

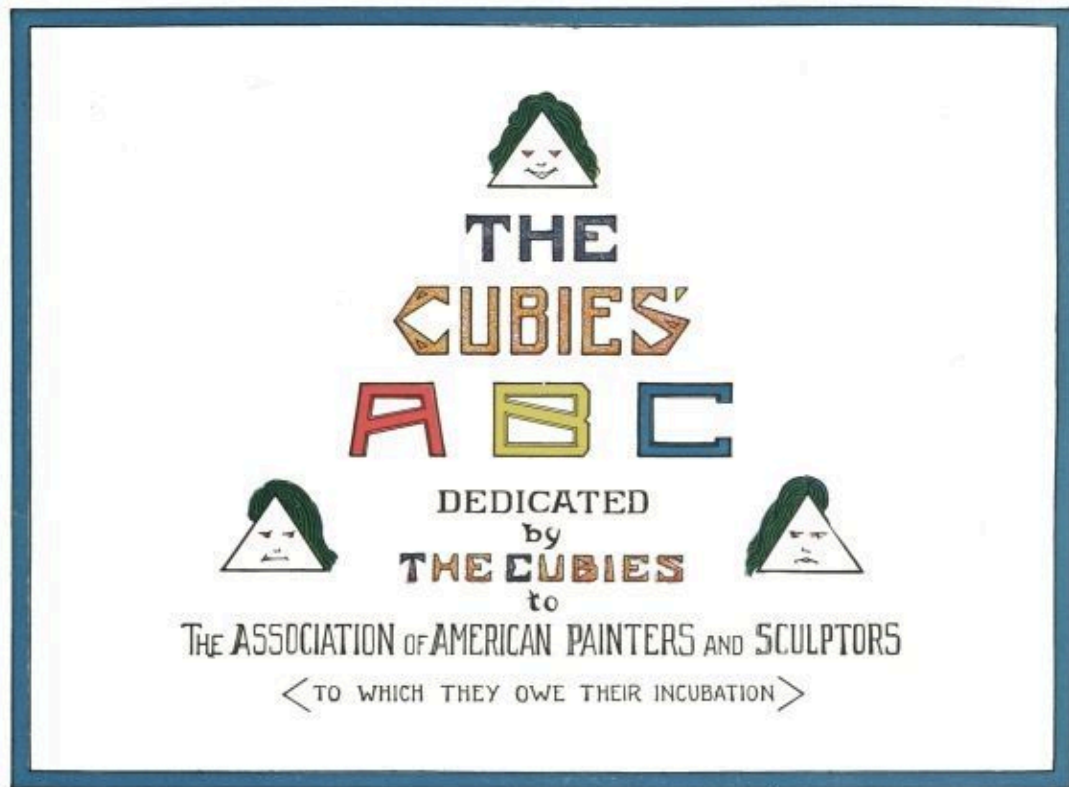
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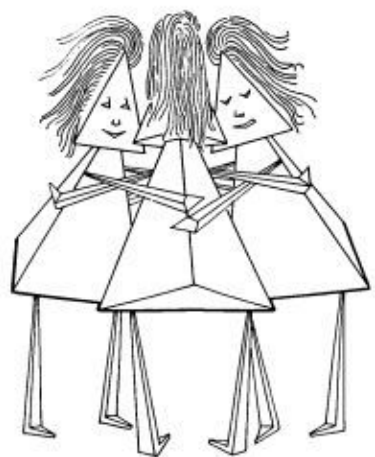
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DEDICATED by THE CUBIES
to
THE ASSOCIATION OF AMERICAN PAINTERS AND SCULPTORS
< TO WHICH THEY OWE THEIR INCUBATION >



△THE CUBIES'△

THE CUBIES'



is for Art in the Cubies' domain—

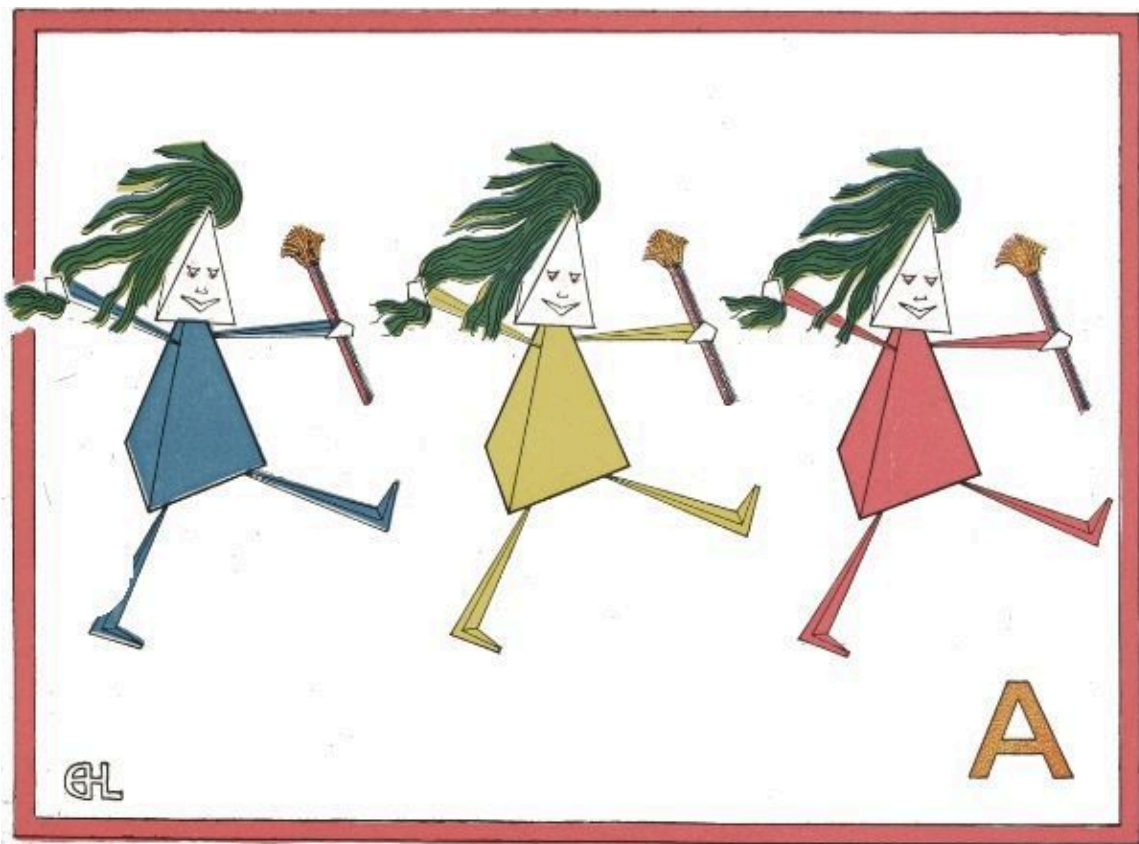
(Not the Art of the Ancients, brand-new are
the Cubies.)

Archipenko's their guide, Anatomics their
bane;

They're the joy of the mad, the despair of
the sane,

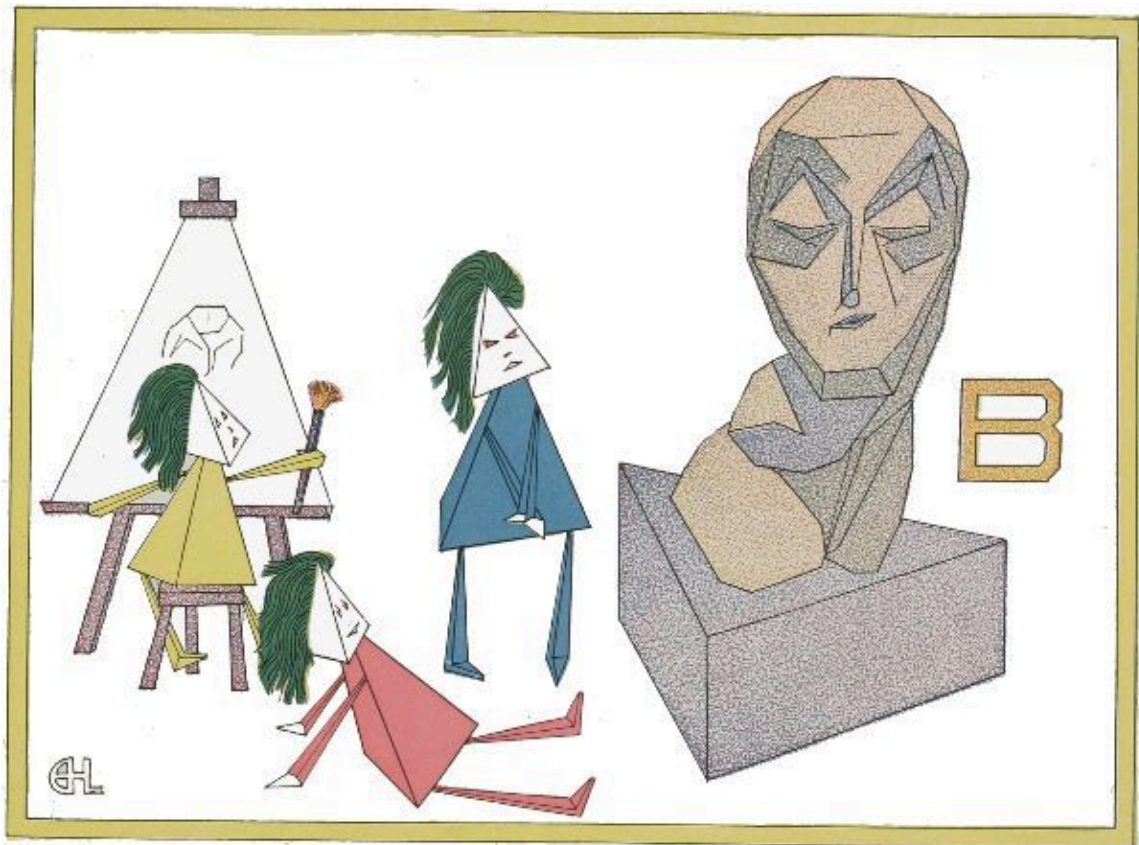
(With their emerald hair and their eyes
red as rubies.)

—A is for Art in the Cubies' domain.



is for Beauty as Brancusi views it.
(The Cubies all vow he and Braque take the
Bun.)

First you seize all that's plain to the eye,
then you lose it;
Next you search for the Soul and proceed to
abuse it.
(They tell me it's easy and no end of
fun.)
—B is for Beauty as Brancusi views it.





is for Color Cubistic ad libitum—

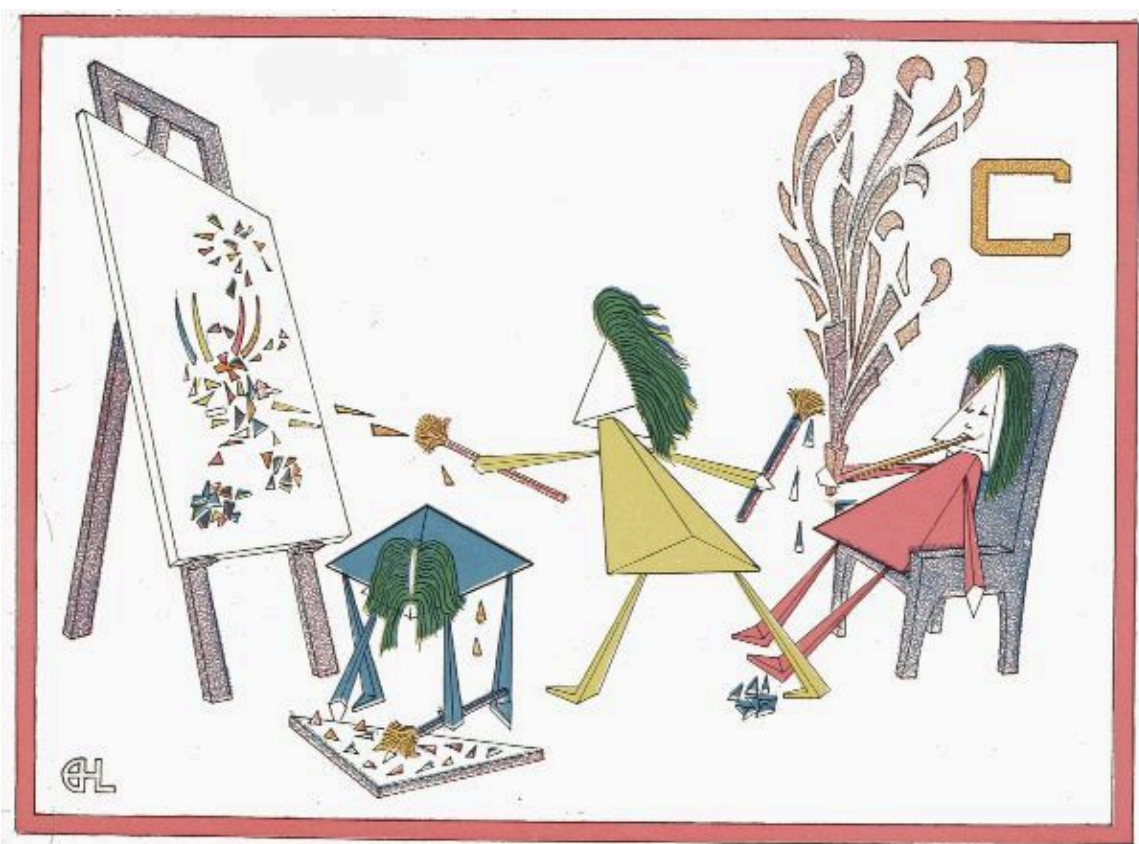
(Orange and blue, yellow, purple and green.)

“Throw them all on your boards,” Cubies
say, “then exhibit ’em!”

There’ll be no colors left, if we don’t soon
prohibit ’em!

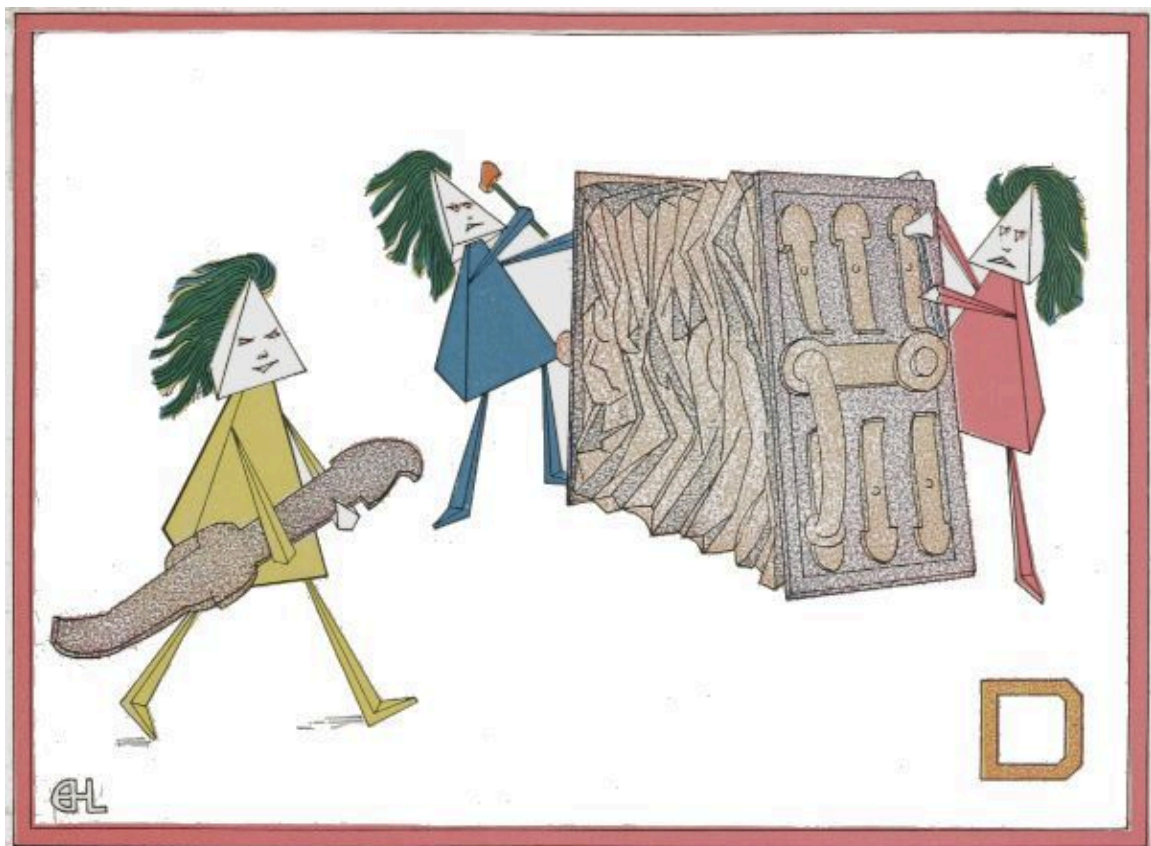
(Watch them at work and you’ll see
what I mean.)

—C is for Color Cubistic ad libitum.



is for Duchamp, the Deep-Dyed Deceiver,
Who, drawing accordions, labels them
stairs,

With a lady that must have been done in a
fever,—
His model won't see her, we trust, it would
grieve her!—
(Should the stairway collapse, Cubie's
good at repairs.)
—D is for Duchamp, the Deep-Dyed
Deceiver.





's for the Ego, intense and Exotic,
Enjoyed by a Cubie, and quaintly Expressed
In a lachrymose face with a gaze idiotic
When seen on the canvas.—It's really
Quixotic
To offer one's soul to the Cubical test!
—E's for the Ego, intense and Exotic.



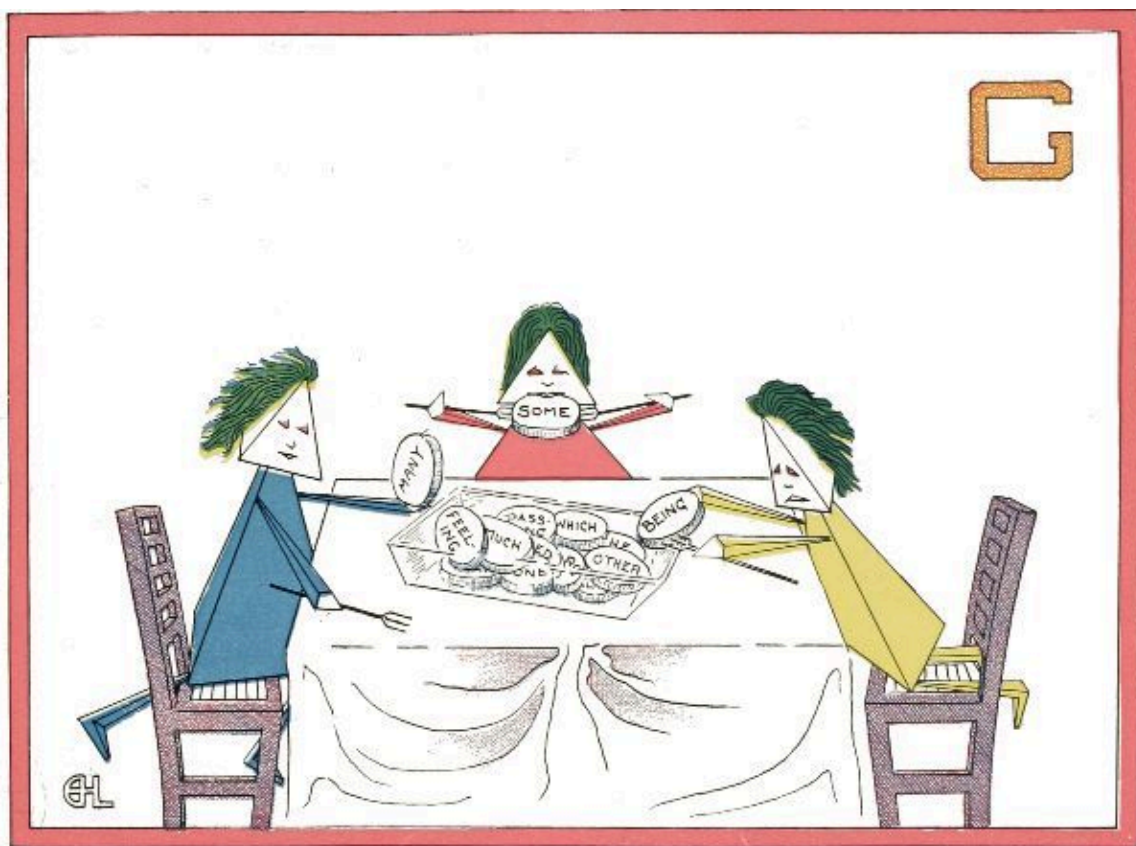
F's for the Future for which Cubies hanker;—
To Hals, Perugino and all that old crew

They give up the Past without envy or
rancor,
While saying in tones than which naught
could be franker:
“Come, move on,—it’s our turn! They
have finished with you.”
—F’s for the Future for which Cubies
hanker.





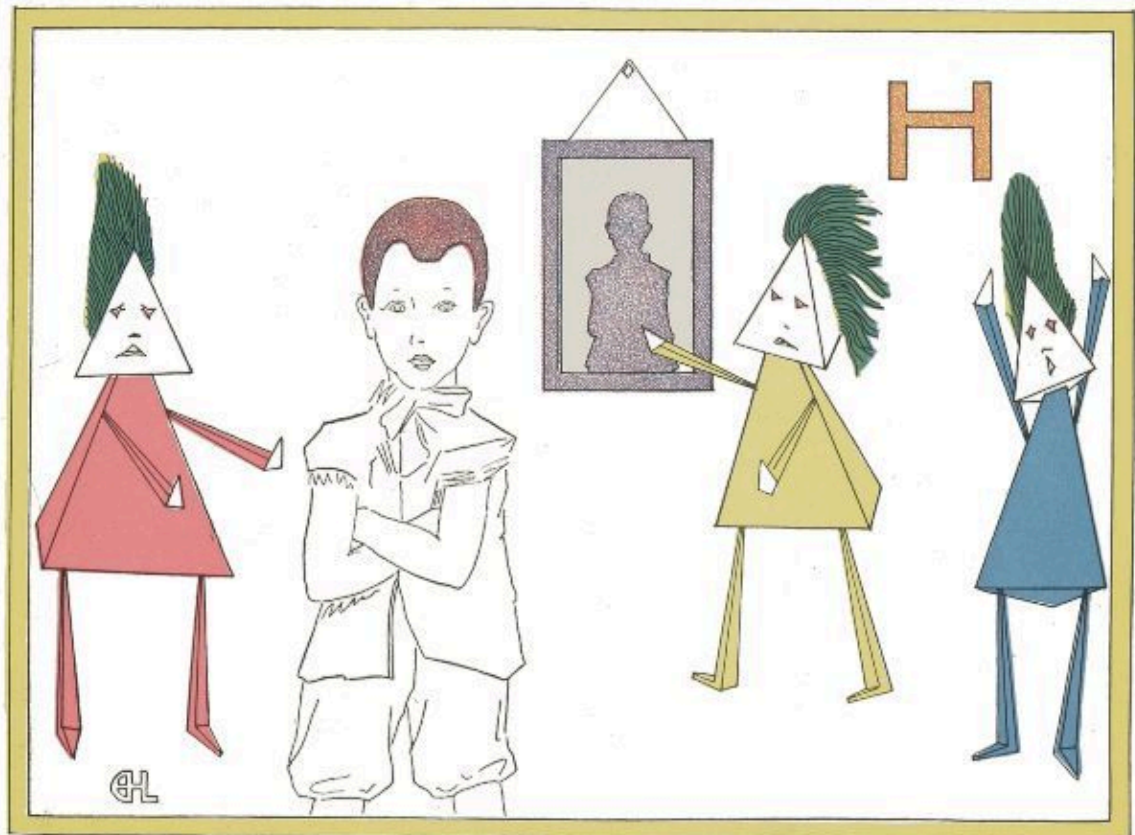
is for Gertrude Stein's limpid lucidity,
(Eloquent scribe of the Futurist soul.)
Cubies devour each word with avidity:
"Alone words lack sense," they affirm with
placidity,
"But *how* wise we'll be when we've
swallowed the whole!"
—G is for Gertrude Stein's limpid lucidity.



H

is for Henri's young Red Top, the shaver
Whom Cubies regard with aversion and
spite.

His life-like appearance has won their
disfavor:
“He might walk right out of the picture!”
they quaver,—
“Why, only to think of it fills us with
fright!”
—H is for Henri’s young Red Top the
shaver.





's for the Cubies' Immense Intuition,—

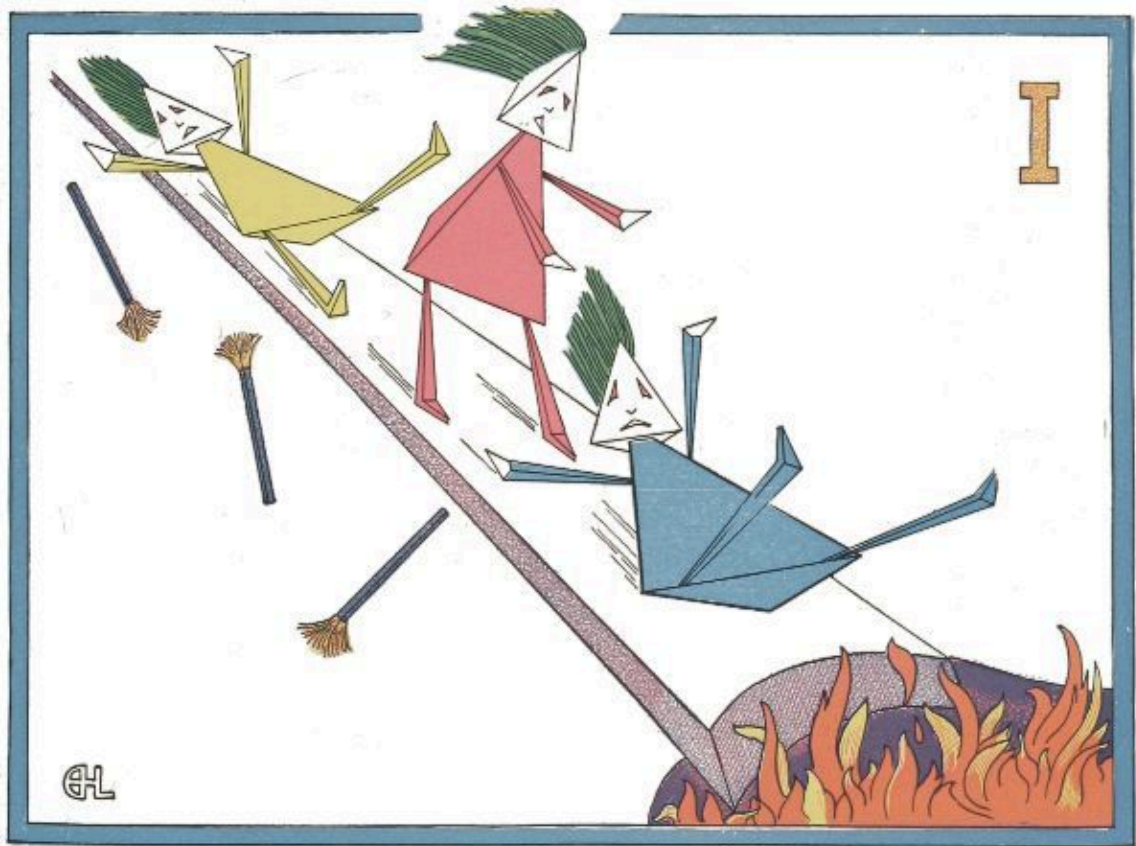
“The only real need of an artist,” they say:

“Without it we all would go straight to
perdition!”

Between you and me, I've a sneaking
suspicion

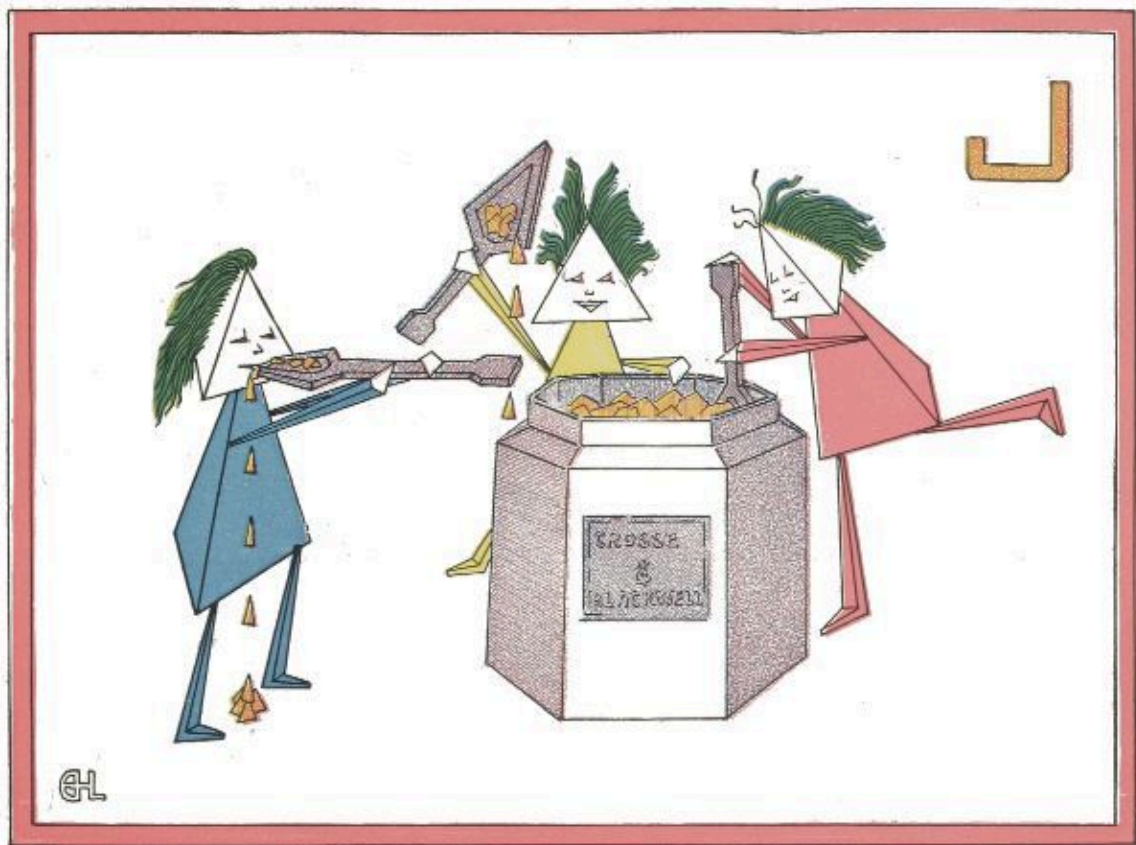
The Cubies themselves appear well on
the way!

—I's for the Cubies' Immense Intuition.



's for the Jam in the Cubies' headquarters,
And the Jar that they gave us, the first time
we met;

And that same Jar of Jam from across the
blue waters
Is quite unexcelled among those the
importers
Have wafted us over the ocean as yet.
—J's for the Jam in the Cubies'
headquarters.





's for Kandinsky's Kute "improvisations"—

The Kubies abound in delight for his art:

They say there's a Klue to his Kryptic

Kreations.

By means of Picabia's deep ratiocinations

Some day we may really decipher his

heart.

—K's for Kandinsky's Kute

"improvisations."



is for Life that is “still,” as they name it,
Or “nature” that’s “dead,” as you readily
see.

When you think how it's treated, you really
can't blame it.
You'd wish, in it's place, *you* were dead.
Just the same it
Is shocking how cruel the Cubies can
be!
—L is for Life that is “still,” as they name it.





's for Matisse's Mam'selle Marguerite,
(With whom all the Cubies are madly in
love;)

Her manner is so prepossessing and sweet
That, if she but had them, we'd fall at her
feet!

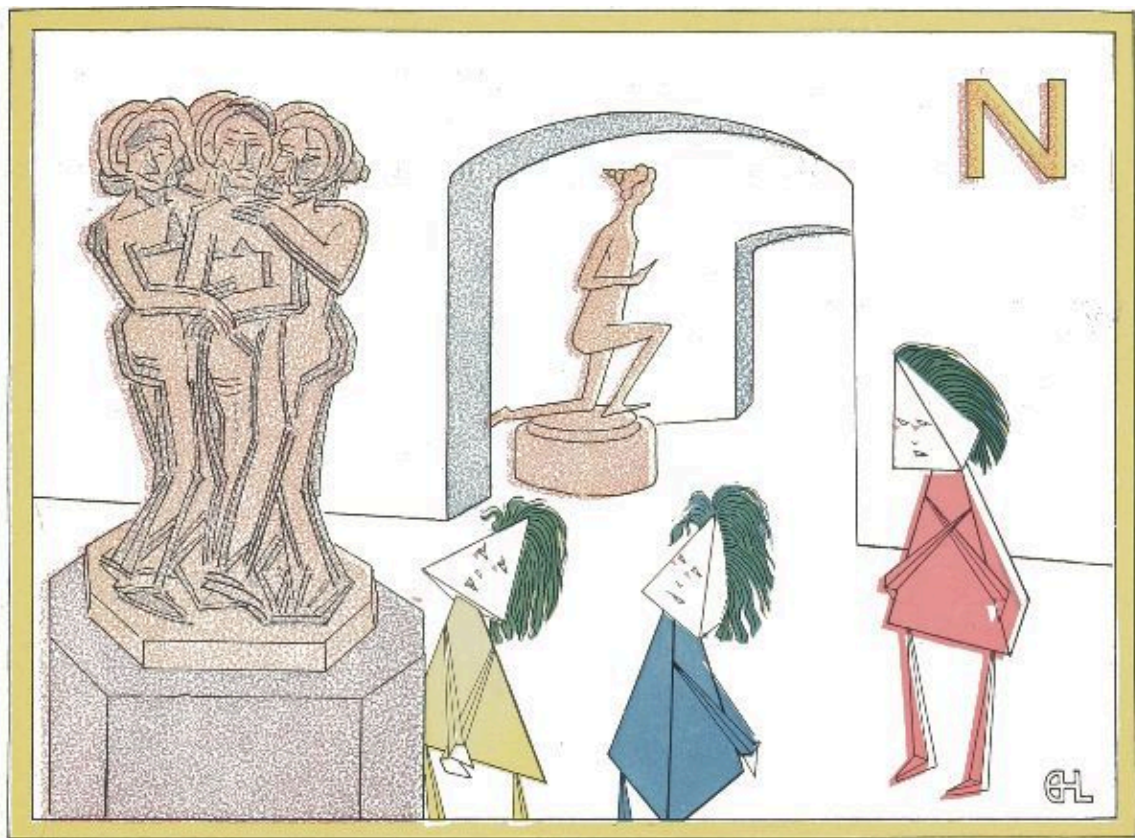
(In her eyes, what a mingling of
serpent and dove!)

—M's for Matisse's Mam'selle Marguerite.



N's for the Nudes that the Cubies portray,—
We willingly vouch for their perfect
propriety,

Even while some we regard with dismay,—
For instance, the lady as long as Broadway:
With all due respect, we don't crave
her society!
—N's for the Nudes that the Cubies portray.





's for Objective and Optical Art,
(The kind we've been used to, these long
years gone by,
Which the Cubie Objects to with all of his
heart:
"Make the Object Subjective," he says, "at
the start,—
Just a matter of Grammar, as easy as
pie!"
—O's for Objective and Optical Art.



's for Picasso, Picabia and Party
(Who deal in abstractions, distractions and
such.)

When, with vision chaotic and expletives
 hearty,
You beg of a Cubie their sense to impart, he
 Profoundly makes answer: “In little is
 much.”
—P’s for Picasso, Picabia and Party.





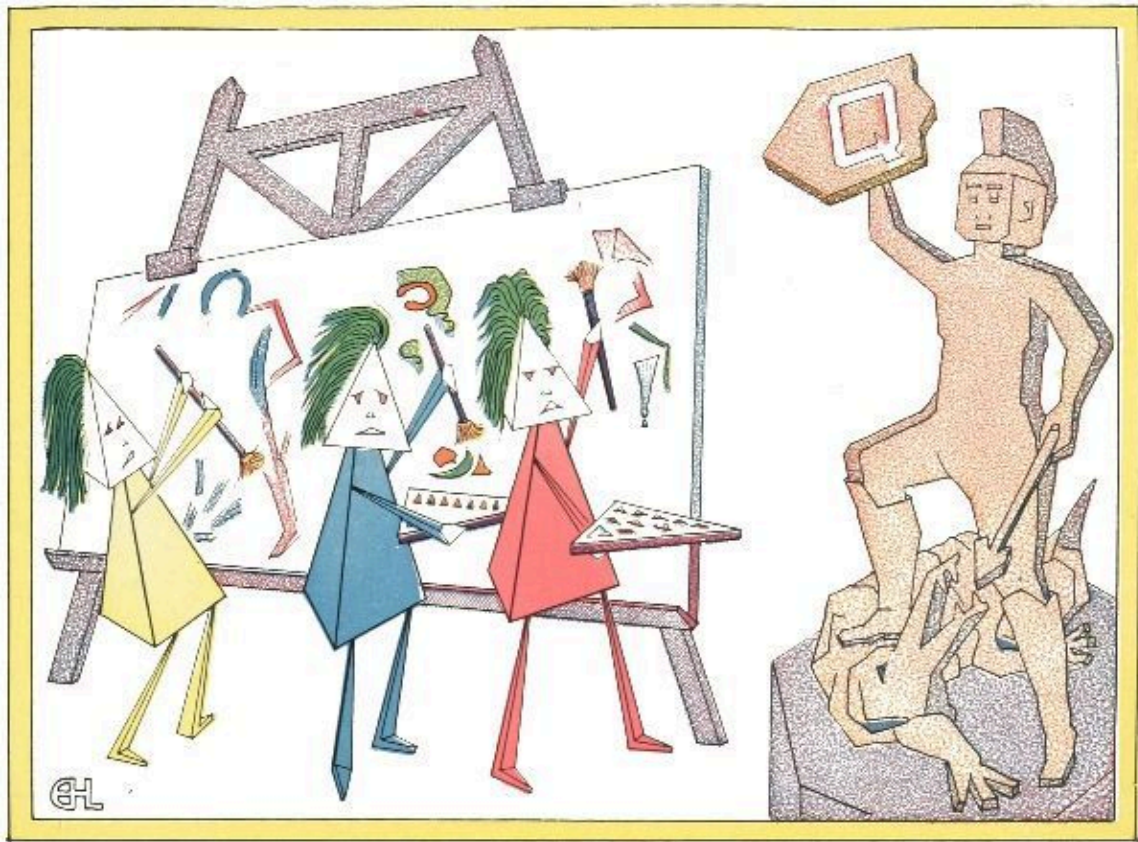
's for the Queerness we Stand-patters feel
When Progressive young Cubies start Art
reformation.

They're strong on Initiative, praise the
Square Deal:

“Though the Cubic is best!” they
aggressively squeal;

“Painting things as you see them is
rank deformation!”

—Q's for the Queerness we Stand-patters
feel.



R

is for Reason and poor old Reality,
Once in the fashion, but now obsolete,
Banished forever with grim actuality.

Now the sole law is one's own personality—
Find its Cube Root and you have it
complete.
—R is for Reason and poor old Reality.



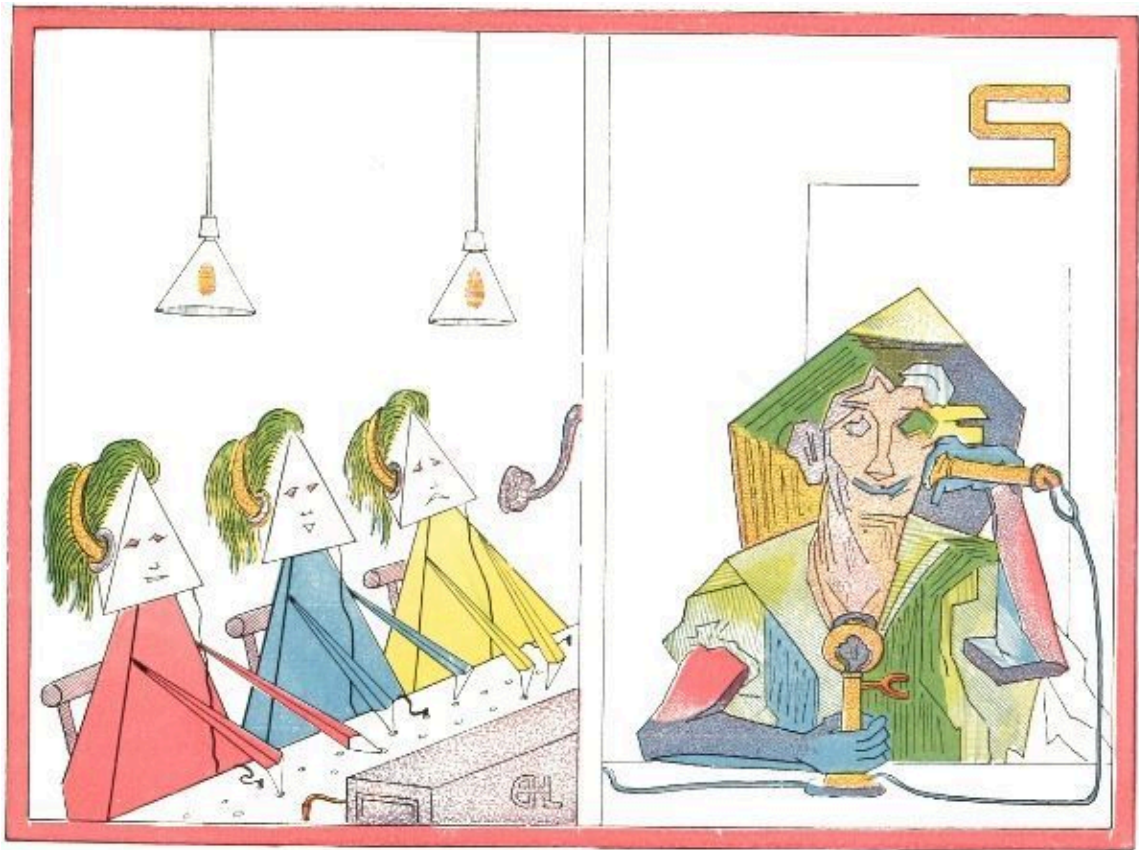


is for Schamberg's fair dame at her 'phone,
Conversing with G. Stein, the Futurist
scribe.

The Cubies, eavesdropping, hear Gertrude
bemoan:

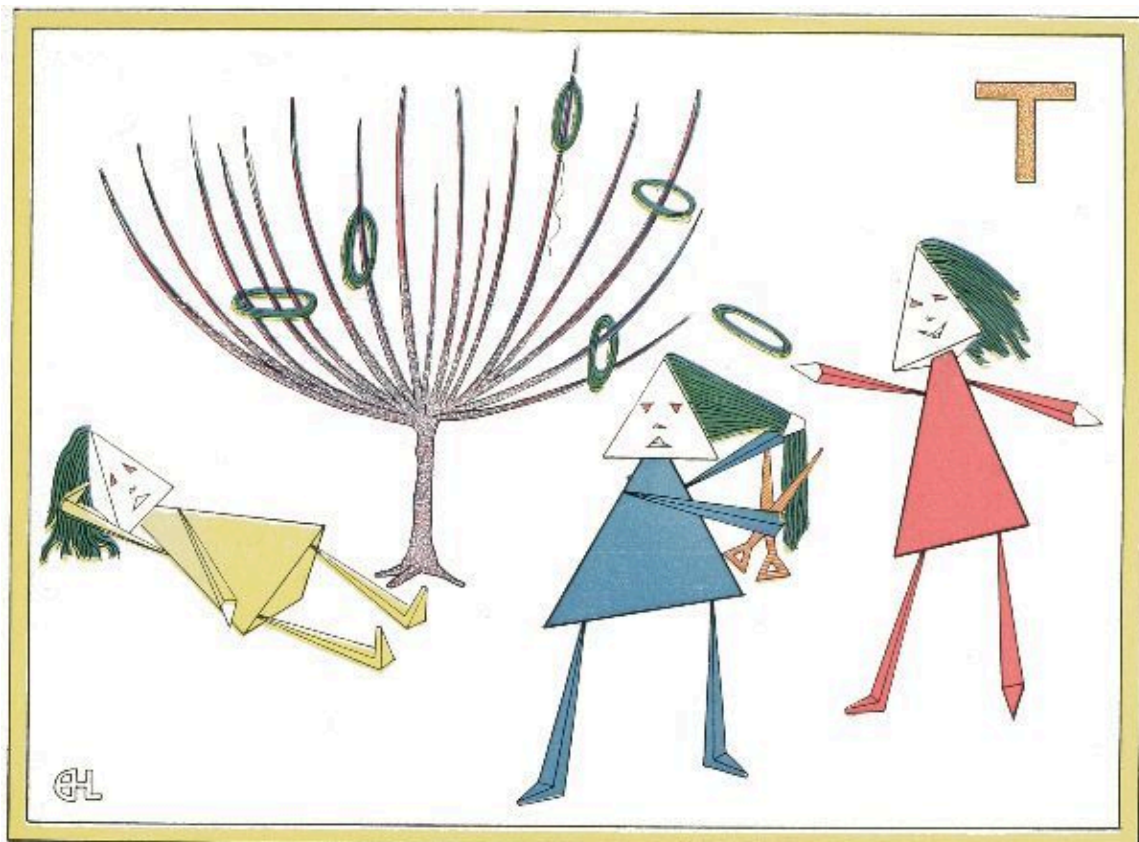
“This one feeling many far seeming alone,
The bluer the bliss the redder the
bribe!”

—S is for Schamberg's fair dame at her
'phone.



T's for the Type of Tree Chabaud's erected.
The Cubies insist it's as useful as fair

For a game that they play when they're
feeling dejected,
(A use which not every one would have
detected,)
Lassoing the branches with rings of
their hair.
—T's for the Type of Tree Chabaud's
erected.





's for the Union so Utterly Useless

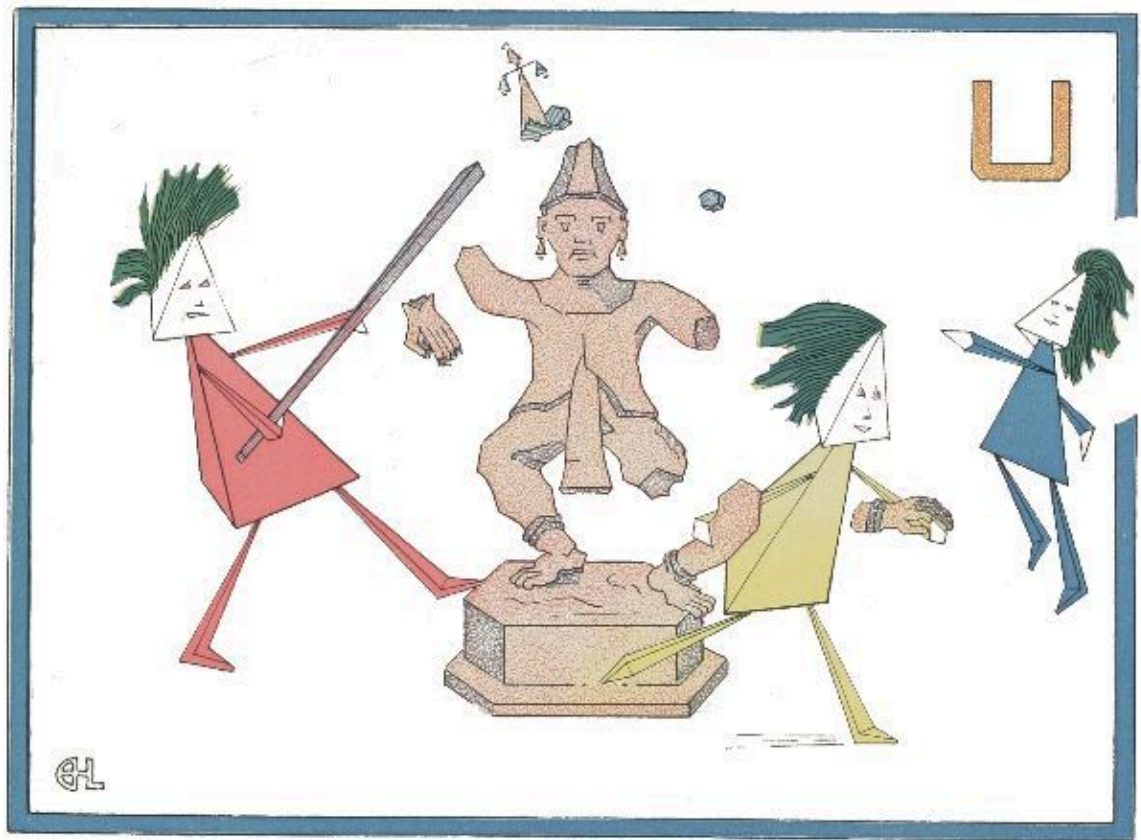
Uniting the members that make up the
whole.

Against it the Cubies wage war that is
truceless:

“Such rage for convention,” they cry, “is
excuseless!

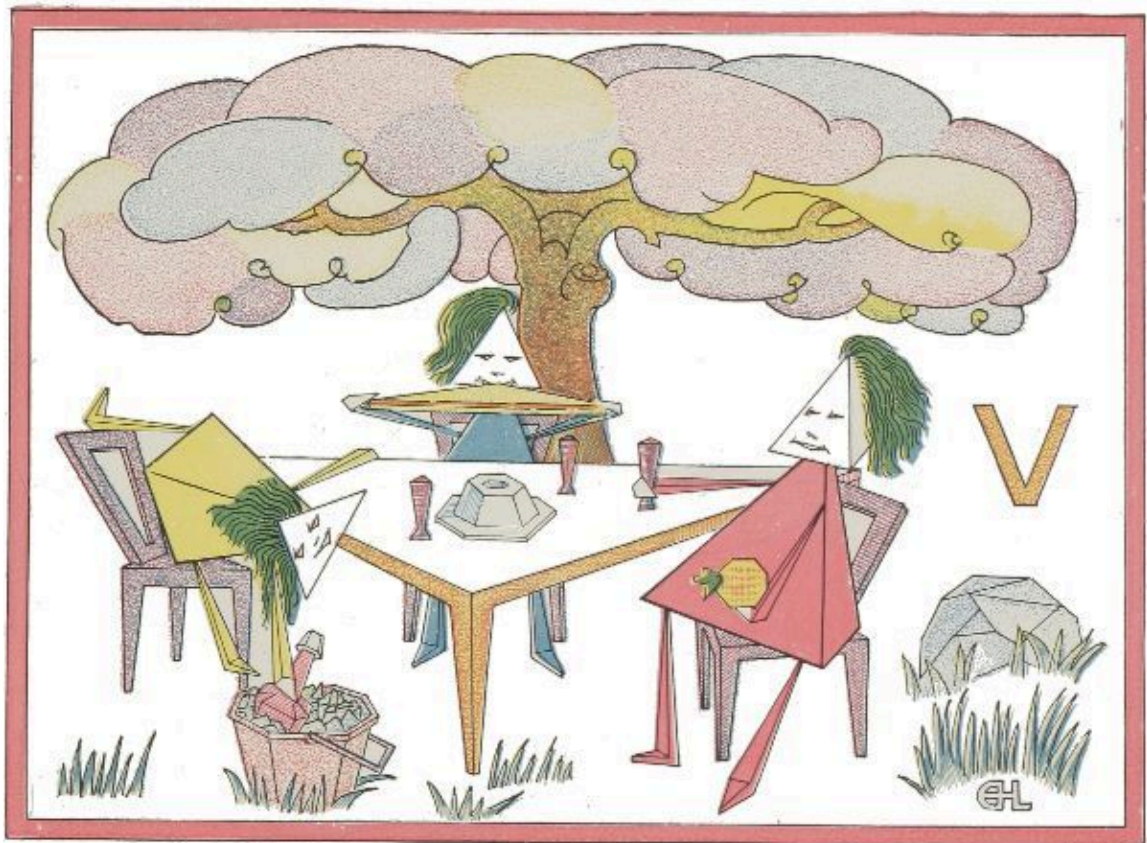
Away with cohesion, and set free the
Soul!”

—U's for the Union so Utterly Useless.



V is for Villon's musicianly lady
(With charm evanescent and Visage remote.)

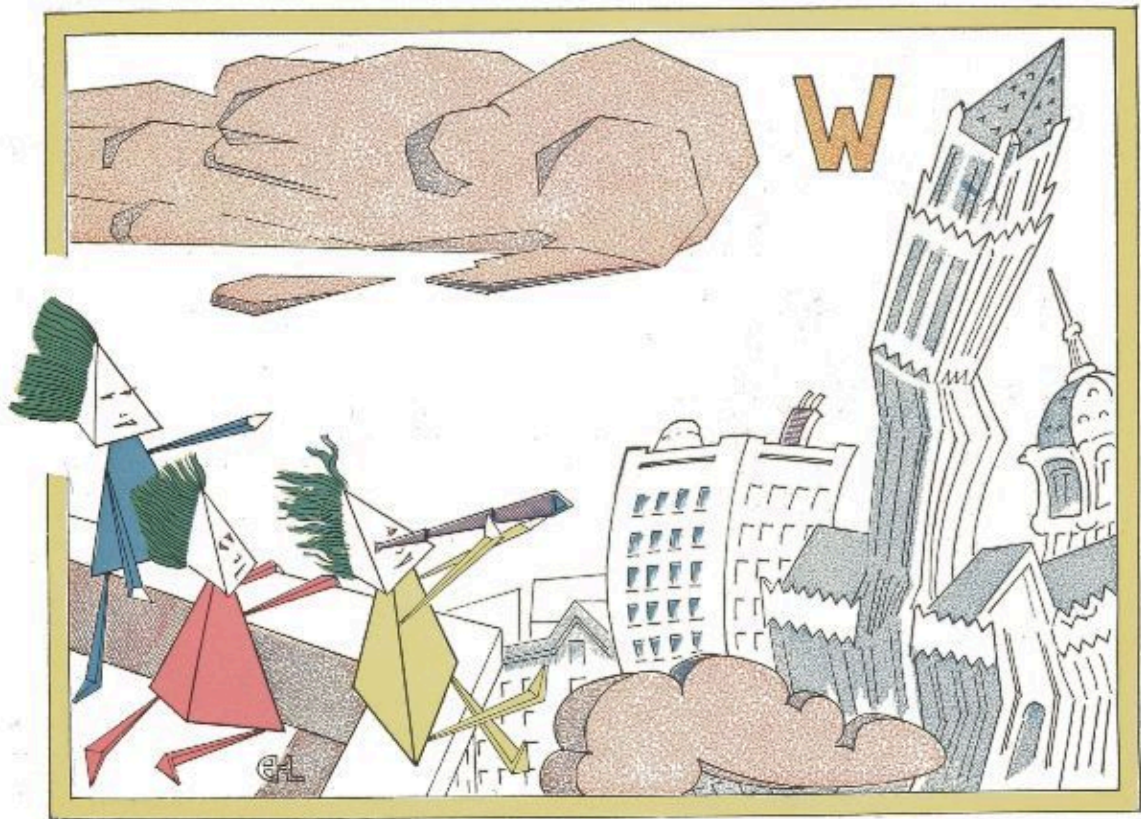
The picnics he gives in his orchards so
shady
Account for his hit with the Cubes. I'm
afraid he
Will spoil them completely for plain
table d'hôte.
—V is for Villon's musicianly lady.





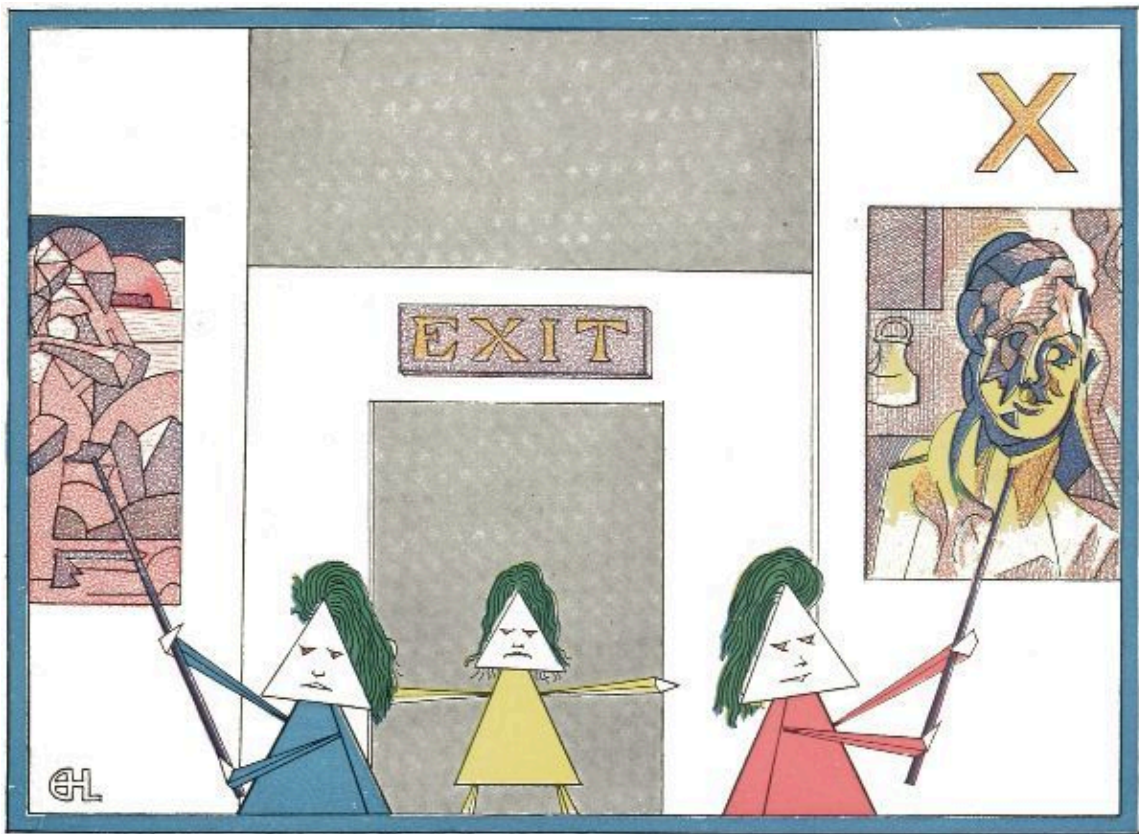
's for Woolworth, the building so stable,
(Erected with nickels and dimes by us all,)
Which Cubies paint writhing from cellar to
gable,
Distinctly resembling the Tower of Babel,
Some decades ago, just preceding its
fall.

—W's for Woolworth, the building so
stable.



X is the Xit, Xtremely alluring
When Cubies invite us to study their Art;
And the Xquisite pain we are sadly enduring

The while they protest, with an air
reassuring:
“Of course this is merely a diffident
start!”
—X is the Xit, Xtremely alluring.





's for the Yawn overcoming each Cubie

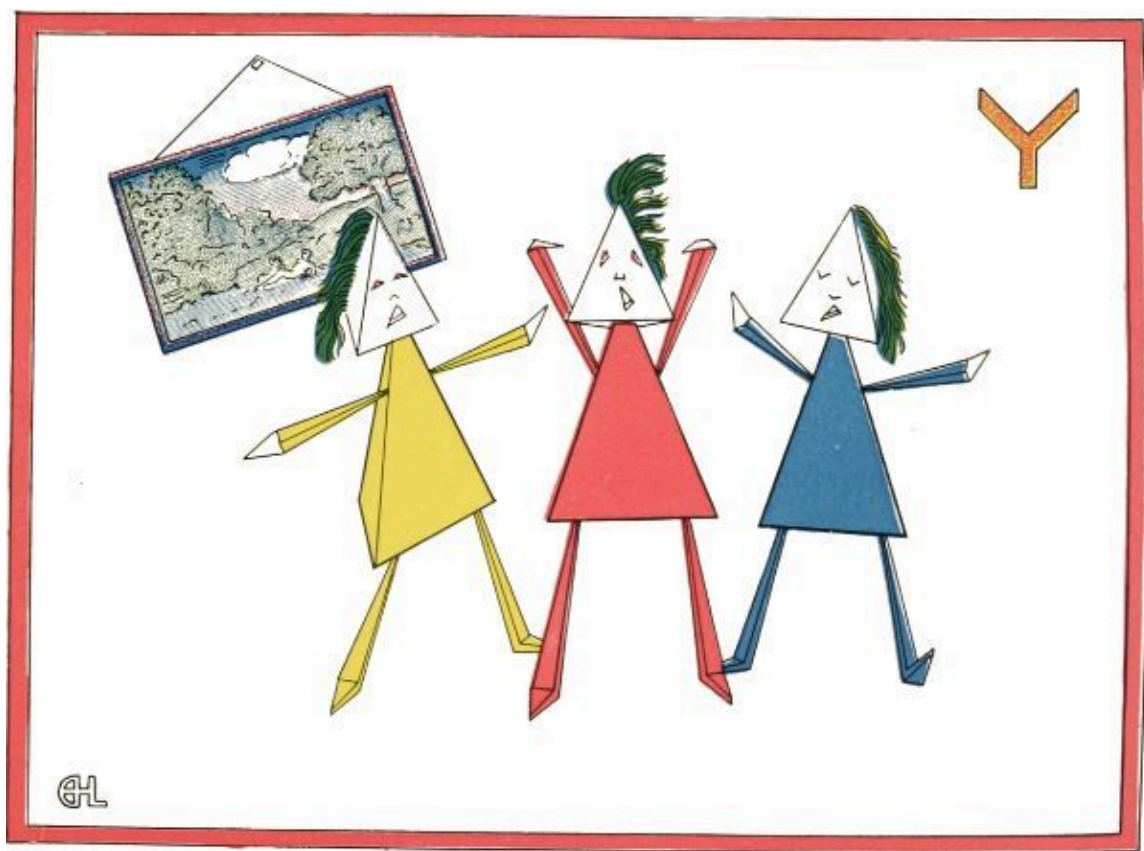
At sight of a painting not done in his style:

“If a man doesn’t use all the colors, from
ruby

To sapphire and emerald and topaz—the
booby!—

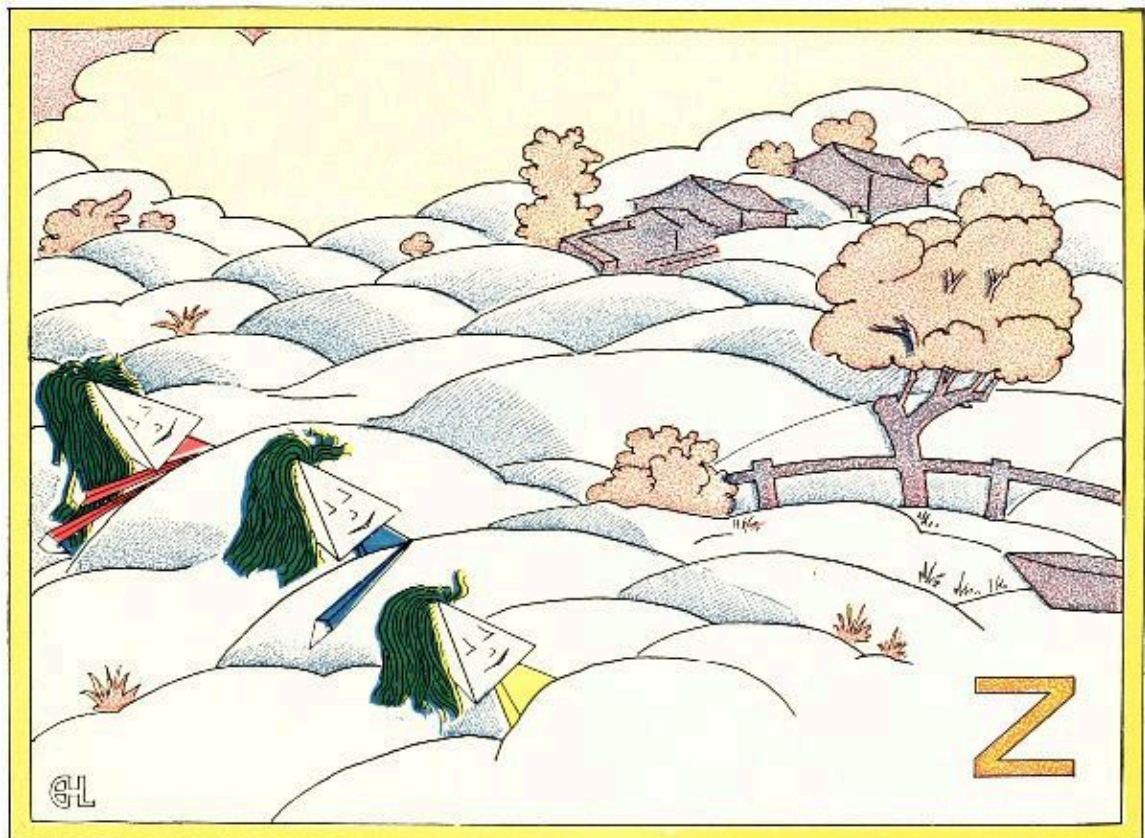
To look at *his* canvas is not worth
one’s while!”

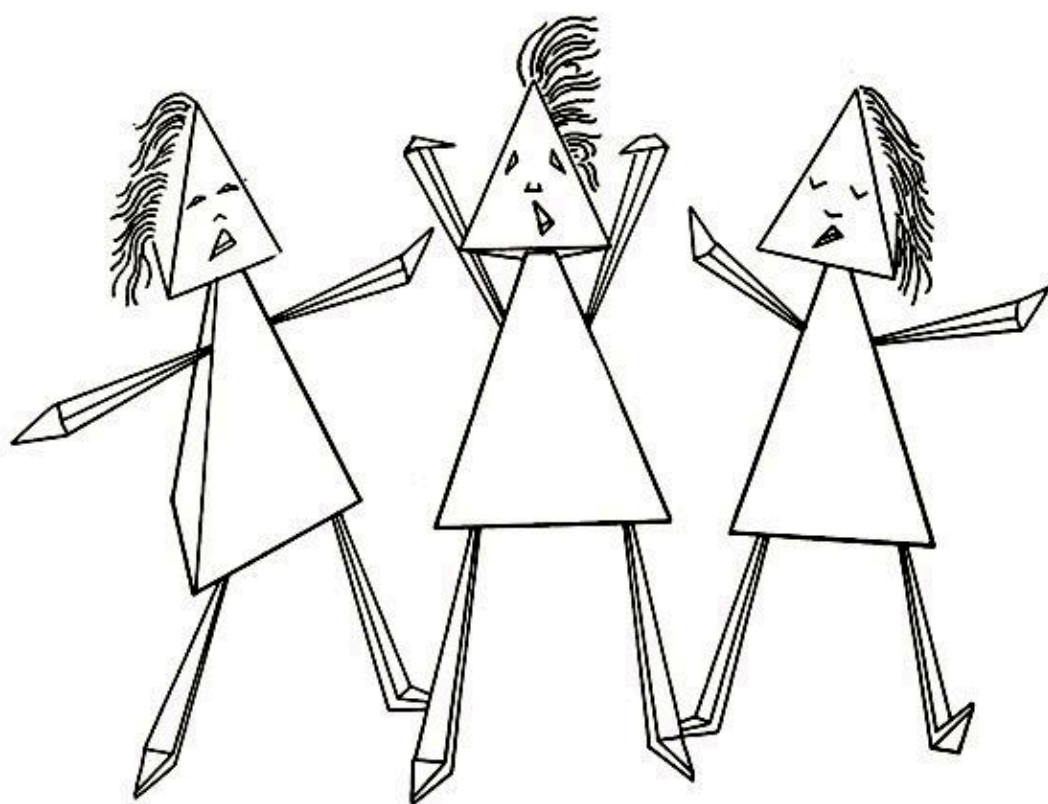
—Y’s for the Yawn overcoming each Cubie.

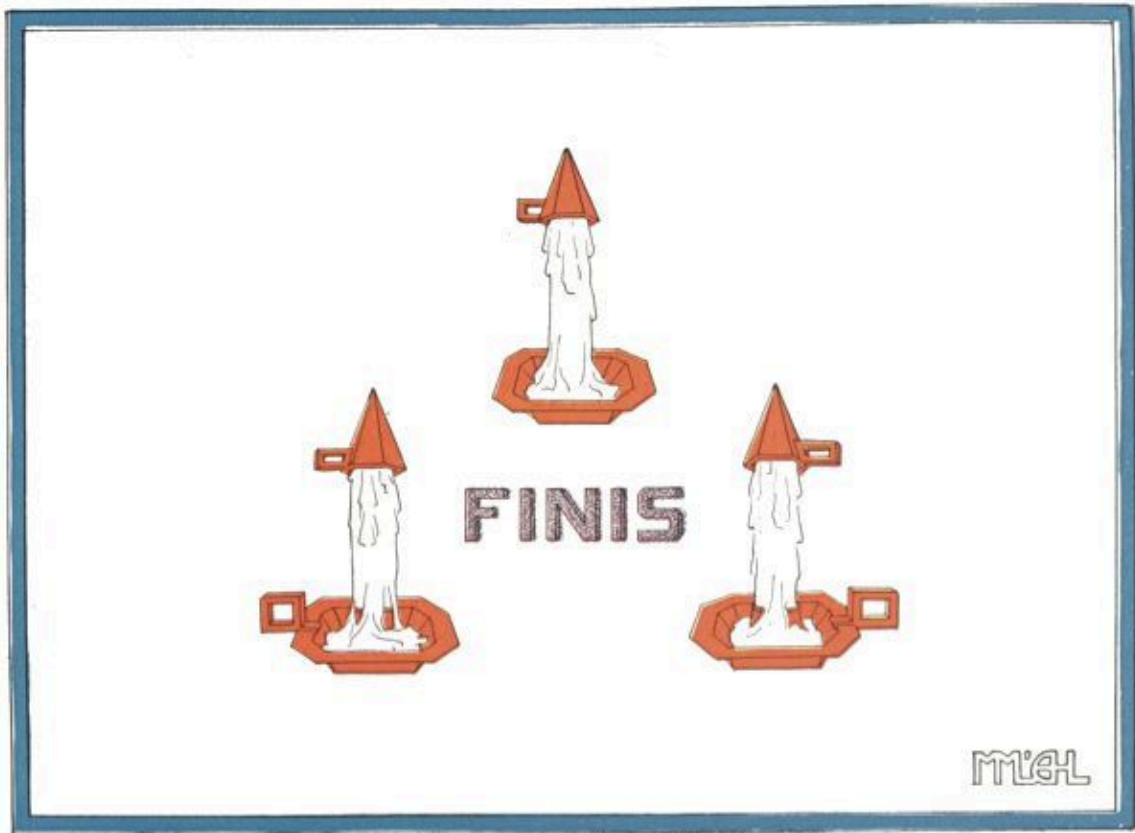


is for Zak's summer-time composition;
The Cubies regard his plump hills with
delight.

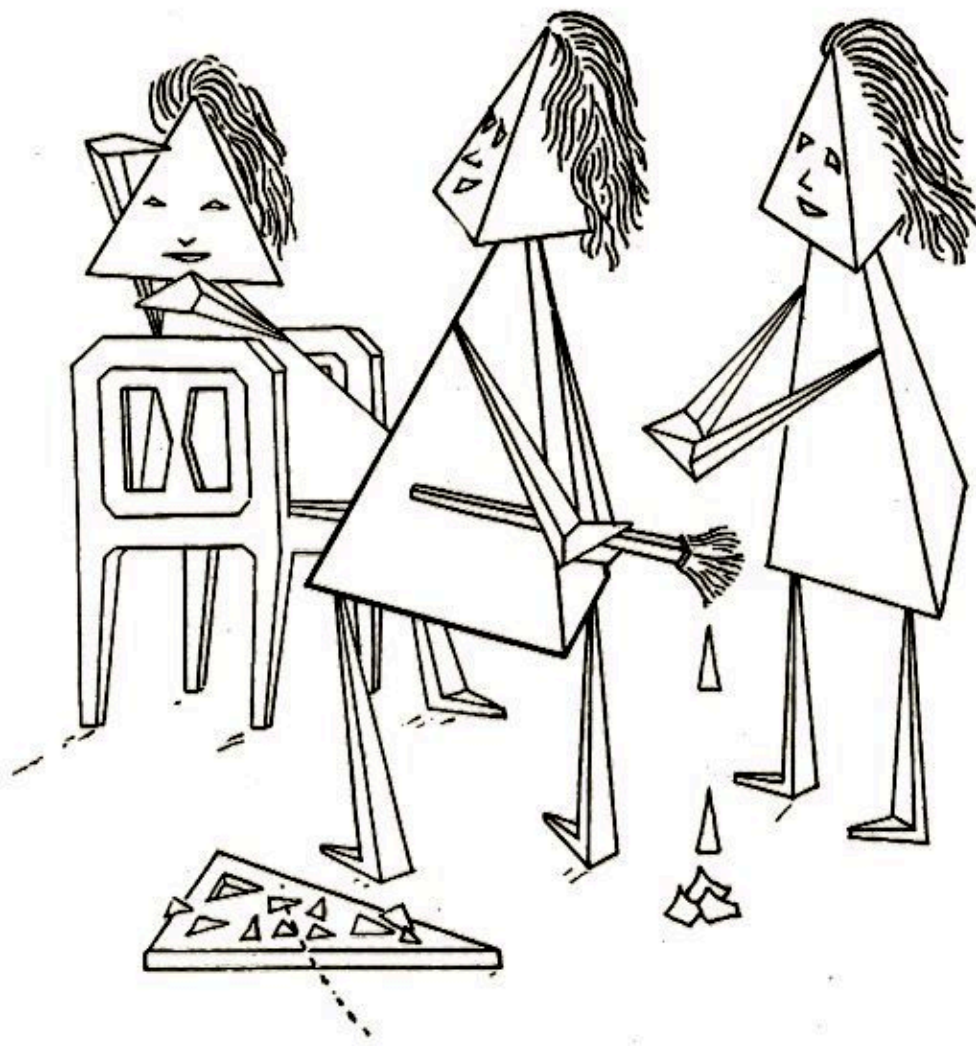
They are somewhat fatigued after this
exhibition
And tempted to slumber; so, with your
permission,
We'll tuck them in snugly and bid
them goodnight.
—Z is for Zak's summer-time composition.

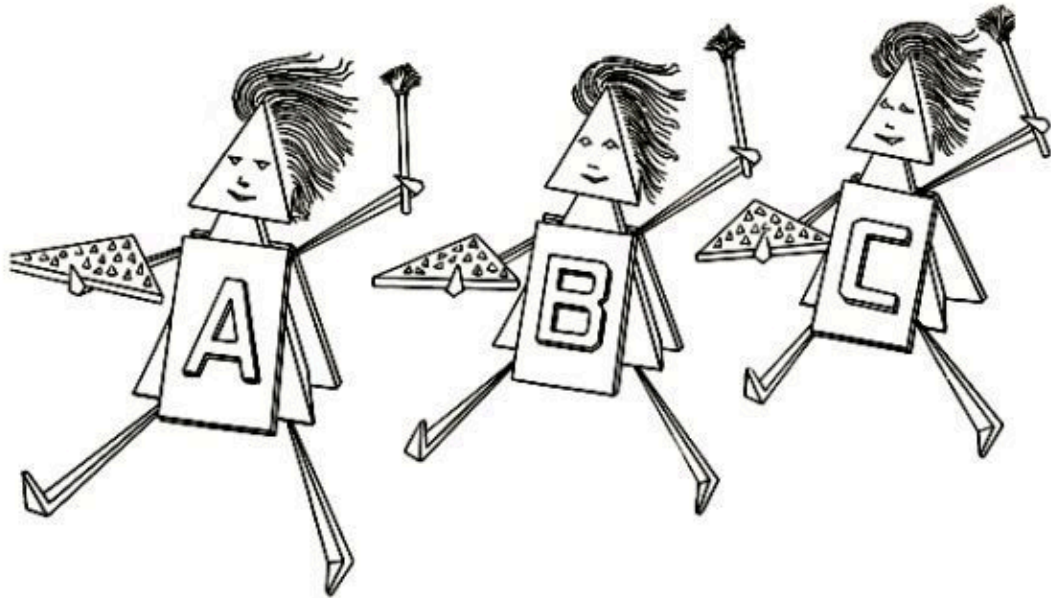




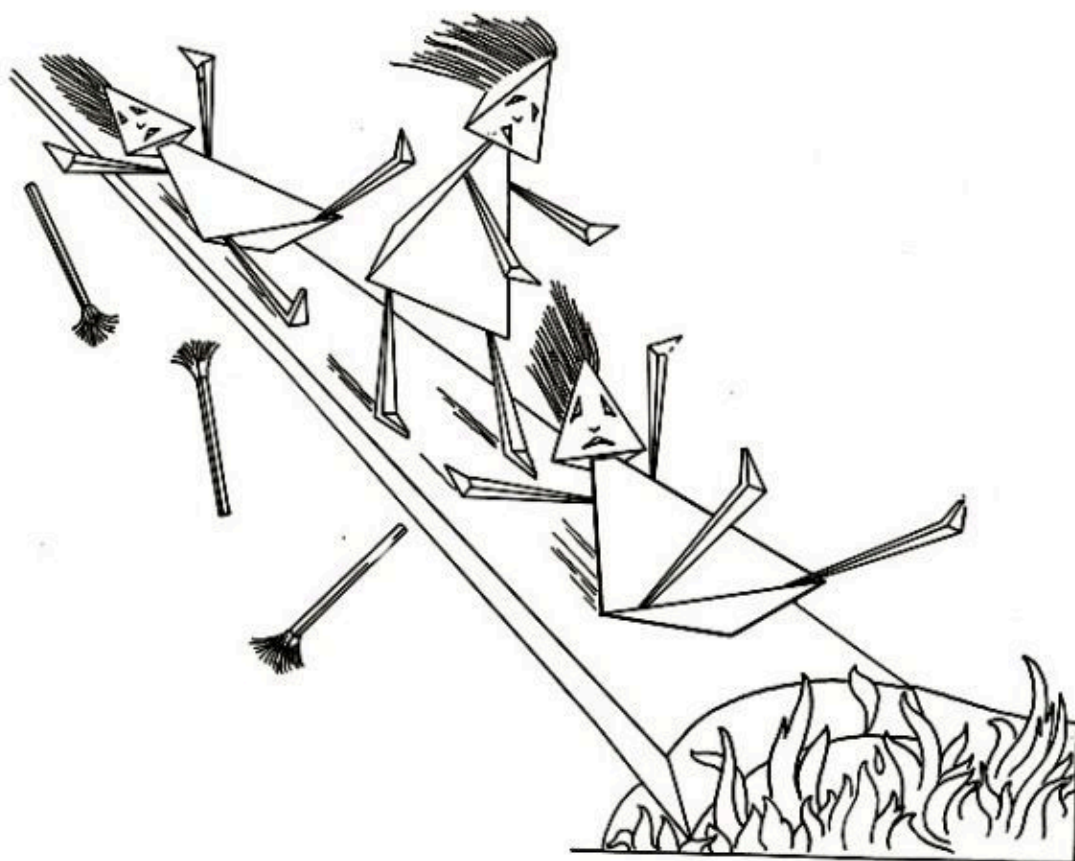


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